

Sewickley Public Library:

Streamlining Event Planning Process and Content Generation Workflow

Executive Summary

April 23, 2026

Background

Established in 1873, Sewickley Public Library (SPL) is the oldest public library in Allegheny County, serving 500+ daily visitors and organizing over 1,297 annual programs for 34,000+ community members. Despite this volume, SPL operates with a lean team of ~15 staff across siloed departments that plan events independently using inconsistent tools (including Excel sheets, Word documents, and email threads) with no shared system for tracking or communicating event data.

Project Description

Project Opportunity

The core opportunity addressed a lack of a single source of truth for event and program data. Event details were scattered across Word documents, Excel sheets, and email threads managed independently by each department. This forced the Head of Communications (Richelle Klug) to spend approximately 3-4 days manually aggregating, reconciling, and re-entering data across multiple platforms. This creates a bottleneck, increasing error risk, and establishing a single-person dependency that limits the library's capacity to scale its programming.

Project Vision

The project implemented a two-part solution: a centralized Monday.com planning workspace that standardizes event data across all departments, and a connected Monday.com → Excel → Figma workflow that turns that data directly into a polished monthly newsletter. Together, these eliminate redundant data entry and manual formatting, freeing the Communications Head from administrative overhead so staff can focus on community engagement.

Project Outcomes

The Monday.com workspace reduced the number of platforms used for event planning from 8 to 1, and communication channels from 4 to 1. Adult and Teen departments have been fully onboarded; the Children's board is developed and ready for adoption. On the newsletter side, the Monday.com → Excel → Figma pipeline cut repetitive formatting

work significantly. By the second test cycle, production time in Figma was already comparable to the previous Canva workflow, with greater consistency and fewer errors.

Project Deliverables

Deliverables include a Monday.com workspace with departmental planning boards, a centralized newsletter board, and embedded documentation; a Figma newsletter design workspace with reusable templates, production files, and a step-by-step guide; and a Google Drive repository containing all project materials, demo recordings, and a handoff document. These materials are all transferred to Richelle Klug.

Recommendations

The team recommends three areas for future development: (1) leveraging the standardized Monday.com workflow to reduce staff onboarding time and improve inter-department communication; (2) building a centralized Admin Board on Monday.com to give leadership aggregate visibility across departments; and (3) pursuing enhanced calendar event automation in Figma once technical capacity or tooling constraints allow.

Student Consulting Team

Cass Ma | *Project Manager*

She is a senior pursuing a dual degree in Information Systems and Film & Visual Media Studies, with a minor in Human-Computer Interaction. She is interested in product management roles in experience-driven industries.

Jonathan Gu | *Tech Lead*

He is a third-year Information Systems student with a minor in software engineering. He will be interning at GitHub as a software engineer intern this summer and Amazon as a software development engineer intern this fall and is working toward a career in software development.

Yuki Ma | *Client Relationship & Communications, Team Leader*

Senior studying Information Systems continuing her education at CMU in Masters in Management Information Systems. Pursuing a career in product management, she has experience working as a business analyst, market researcher, and product manager at big tech companies (i.e. Amazon).